

Figure 1: gVim first look

home directory, and point the installation to it. So in my case, it is `C:\Users\Admin\vim`.



Note: You can use the lowercase 'v' in 'vim'. I just happen to like 'Vim'.

Please remember to select the 'Full' option during installation as shown in Figure 3. After you are done with the installation, it'll look like what's shown in Figure 1. It's now time to change a few things.

Shuffle the folders and move them around

When you now look under the Vim folder, you'll find that it has:

- 1) A `vim74` folder, where the `gVim/vim` executable and other related files reside.
- 2) A file called `_vimrc`, which is the game changer Vim configuration file. In Linux, it's named `.vimrc`.
- 3) Another folder called `vimfiles`. This is where we will make a couple of changes. It will have a lot of folders, all of which are empty.



Note: You can skip moving/deleting folders, and simply create two folders under 'vimfiles' - one will be 'autoload' and another 'bundle', but I prefer the following method. It works fine and reduces clutter.

First, delete all the folders in the 'vimfiles' folder, but don't delete 'vimfiles' itself. Then, open the 'vim74' folder and you'll find another folder under it called 'autoload'. Cut and paste that folder under 'vimfiles' so that it now has only the 'autoload' folder. Next, create another folder in 'vimfiles' called 'bundle'. Your 'vimfiles' folder will now have 'autoload' (which you moved from the 'vim74' folder) and 'bundle' folders.

If you just created new folders as mentioned above and did not delete/move the folders, you'll have a lot more in there. Re-open gVim, to ensure that you are not getting any error messages. If you do, please reinstall gVim and follow the above steps.

Git and Pathogen: plugin power to gVim

To describe it very briefly, Git is a revision control system in which programmers can share their code. It's much more



Figure 2: gVim modified



Figure 3: Select 'Full'

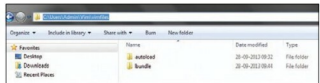


Figure 4: vimfiles

than that, though, and information about it can be obtained on the Internet.

Pathogen is what makes life easier for Vim users. It's written by Tim Pope, the Vim and Vimscript expert. It makes installing or uninstalling plugins super easy. The Vim plugins and related files are spread across many Vim directories. Adding or removing them by hand could be both painful and dangerous. Thankfully, Pathogen makes it easier.

So let's install Git and then Pathogen.

Head off to <http://git-scm.com/downloads> and download the Windows version. I've installed it in my home directory as that's where I like it. That way, I just copy my home directory to a pen drive and use it anywhere I go.

There are two things you need to remember here. First, you must ensure that the 'Git cheetah plug-in' option is selected. It probably will be, by default, but it never hurts to make sure it is. The 'True type font option for Windows Console' selection is optional.

Second, during installation, ensure that the 'Run Git from